

# Deep ocean

In open oceans, the water below about 660 ft (200 m) is too dark for plankton to make food using the energy of sunlight. Animals that live there must either visit the surface to feed, prey on each other, or eat debris sinking down from above. Most ocean-floor animals are scavengers or hunters. The only exceptions are the creatures that live around deep-sea volcanic vents.



## UP AND DOWN

Swarms of zooplankton such as these tiny copepods swim up from the twilight zone at night to feed on plantlike phytoplankton near the ocean surface. They are trailed by hunters such as hatchetfish, which have upward-pointing eyes so they can see their prey against the faint starlight filtering down from above.

## GLOWING IN THE DARK

Many deep-ocean creatures glow blue or green in the dark—a feature called bioluminescence. Some use this to attract mates, or to confuse enemies. A few hunters use red “spotlights” to target their prey, which cannot see red light. Some twilight-zone animals use blue light as camouflage, because it exactly matches the faint blue glow from the ocean surface.



## DEEP DIVERS

The mighty sperm whale dives deep into the twilight zone to prey on squid—including giant squid that can grow up to 46 ft (14 m) long. The air-breathing whale has special adaptations that enable it to stay underwater for up to 90 minutes before it has to come back to the surface to breathe.

## ► GLITTER BALL

*This jellyfish uses a chemical reaction to emit an eerie blue light.*

